



Xiaomi MI Portable Speaker

Xiaomi launches Mi Portable Speaker and Mi Neckband Earphones Pro.
<http://dgit.in/mar21-75>



Oppo 125W Flash Charger

Oppo shows off its 125W flash charger at the Mobile World Congress in Shanghai.
<http://dgit.in/mar21-76>

HIFIMAN BW200

Strictly mediocre

HIFIMAN is a relatively well-known brand in the audiophile circles due to stellar products such as the HIFIMAN Sundara and the exorbitantly-priced HIFIMAN Shangri-La. We even tested the HIFIMAN TWS600, a mid-range true wireless in-ear headphone, that impressed us with its sonic accuracy. In this review, we are testing the company's new offering, the HIFIMAN BW200, which is a budget wireless earphone. Let's see if it manages to impress.

Build and comfort

The HIFIMAN BW200 sports a simple wireless in-ear headphone design although it doesn't have a hard plastic neckband, as seen on many wireless earphones these days. Instead, there's a flat tangle-resistant wire that goes around the neck and continues down to the earbuds. Each side has a remote box, one with all the buttons and LEDs, and one bare (just for balancing purposes). The buttons have decent tactile feedback but are sometimes hard to find and press since they sit flush with the remote box's body. The earbuds themselves are pretty ergonomic and fit relatively snugly inside the ear, however, the nozzles aren't angled, which make them slightly less secure in the ear than earbuds with angled nozzles.

The remote boxes on both sides are well-balanced and the earphones don't tug on one side due to this. The cable is flat and tangle resistant, which we always appreciate. Overall, the HIFIMAN BW200 are particularly striking to look at but are comfortable and decently-built earphones for the sub-2K price range.

Features

If you're looking for a pair of feature-laden wireless earphones, the HIFIMAN BW200 isn't neces-



sarily the way to go. Even the Redmi SonicBass earphones which cost merely Rs 999 come equipped with a larger feature set than these earphones. The earphones are powered by Bluetooth v4.1, which is pretty dated for 2020-2021. They come with an IPX4 water resistance rating, which means the earphones can endure a few light splashes. There's no extra codec support such as AAC and aptX, just the standard SBC codec. However, at this price range, it is easy to forgive that. What isn't that easy to forgive and forget is the lack of voice assistant support, so you can't control Google Assistant or Siri with the onboard controls on this device, which is disappointing. Moreover, the earphones come with micro-USB charging, when most have moved on to USB Type-C. One thing we were impressed with, however, was the battery life. For a pair of budget wireless earphones, the HIFIMAN BW200 has surprisingly decent battery life. Rated at 12 hours of play-time, we performed our own tests to corroborate these numbers and found that the buds last at least 11 hours from a full charge.

Performance

HIFIMAN is a company well-known for its audio mastery, however, the BW200 doesn't match the calibre of other offerings from the company.

The sound profile is pretty dark, meaning the bass is too boosted and the highs are underemphasised to some degree. This creates a broody and dark sound tone which doesn't sound good with many genres of music. For example, in the track Hysteria by Muse, the drums are too overpowering and they heavily veil the clarity and detail in the mids and highs. The lead guitar and cymbals in this track are heavily veiled causing the song to fall flat on its face.

Even in bass-focused tracks, the earphones produce slightly boomy bass which takes away from the entire experience. The mids on these earphones actually sound pretty detailed and rich, however, heavy auditory masking from the bass regions of the frequency chart mar the quality of the mids. All in all, there

are other earphones in this price range that do a better job at balancing the frequencies. For instance, the Redmi SonicBass does come with a bass bias, but the bass doesn't overpower the mids and highs to a degree where they lose all their detail.

Verdict

Priced at Rs 1,999 but available for Rs 1,490 on other e-commerce platforms, the HIFIMAN BW200 is a relatively well-built pair of headphones that lacks finesse in the sound quality. The sound profile is quite dark and the bass response overwhelms the details and nuances in the mids and highs. The lack of voice assistant support and the dated Bluetooth v4.1 implementation, makes these buds slightly hard for us to recommend to users.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

MODEL NO: BW200 | BATTERY LIFE: 12hrs | QUICK CHARGE: Yes | IP RATING: IPX4 | WEIGHT: 20g | IN-LINE CONTROLLERS: Yes | MICROPHONE: Yes | MAGNETIC EARBUDS: Yes | WARRANTY PERIOD: 1 Year

CONTACT

HIFIMAN | PHONE: 1-201-443-4626 | EMAIL: customerservice@hifiman.com | WEBSITE: <https://hifiman.com/#1>